

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1520

By Russell

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Dustin Frank, Brian Fernandez, Anthony Blackwell, and Terry McConkey for providing aid during an incident at Kefauver Park.

WHEREAS, the Volunteer State is especially proud to be the home of so many valiant individuals who perform above and beyond the call of duty in an emergency situation; and

WHEREAS, on April 14, 2026, a Madisonville city employee, Tyler Copeland, was trapped under an overturned mower in a pond at Kefauver Park while performing routine maintenance duties for the Madisonville Parks and Recreation Department; and

WHEREAS, taking swift and life-saving action, Madisonville Parks and Recreation employee Dustin Frank, bystander Terry McConkey, and Brian Fernandez and Anthony Blackwell, two inmates assigned to the Monroe County Sheriff's Office work release program, raced into the water and pulled the victim from underneath the lawnmower; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Blackwell grabbed the victim and pulled him to the embankment while Mr. Fernandez helped lift him out of the pond and onto dry ground, where Mr. Frank began performing CPR; and

WHEREAS, initially, the Mr. Copeland had no pulse and was not breathing, but the group continued to perform CPR and attempted to clear water from his airway and stomach; when EMS arrived, he had regained consciousness and was able to breathe and communicate; and

WHEREAS, upon their arrival, Monroe County EMS and the Madisonville Fire Department assumed medical care of the patient who was transported to the hospital for further treatment; and

WHEREAS, no doubt, the quick response and coordinated efforts of bystanders, city personnel, and emergency responders played a critical role in saving the life of Mr. Copeland; and

WHEREAS, it is wholly fitting that we recognize these exemplary gentlemen for their exceptional act of heroism; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and commend Dustin Frank, Brian Fernandez, Anthony Blackwell, and Terry McConkey for their lifesaving response to the accident at Kefauver Park on April 14, 2026.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.